BuildRight Construction - General Site Safety Regulations

Document SSR-01, revision 4

1. Purpose and scope

These regulations apply to every person who enters a BuildRight construction site: employees, subcontractors, temporary workers, drivers making deliveries and visitors. They set the minimum rules; specific procedures (PPE rules PPE-02, scaffolding and work-at-height procedure WAH-03, incident reporting procedure IR-04 and equipment manuals) add more detailed requirements. Where two documents conflict, the stricter requirement applies.

2. Roles and responsibilities

The Site Manager is responsible for the overall safety of the site. He or she approves the site safety plan, chairs the weekly safety meeting and has authority to stop any work that presents an imminent danger.

The Site Safety Officer (SSO) carries out daily inspections, keeps the safety register up to date, checks that permits to work are valid and is the first contact for any safety question.

Supervisors and foremen must brief their crews every morning (toolbox talk of at least 10 minutes), check that each worker has the correct PPE and training, and report hazards to the SSO the same day.

Every worker has the right and the duty to stop work if he or she believes a situation is unsafe ("Stop Work Authority"). No one may be disciplined for using Stop Work Authority in good faith.

3. Site access and induction

No one may work on site before completing the site induction. The induction lasts at least 45 minutes and covers site layout, emergency exits and assembly point, main hazards, PPE requirements and the incident reporting procedure. After the induction, the worker signs the induction register and receives a site badge.

Visitors must be accompanied at all times by a badge holder, wear the minimum PPE (helmet, high-visibility vest, safety footwear) and stay on marked pedestrian routes.

Minimum working age on site is 18 years. Apprentices aged 16 to 17 may only work under the direct supervision of a qualified worker and may not operate lifting equipment.

4. General rules of conduct

Alcohol and drugs are strictly forbidden on site. Any worker who appears to be under the influence is immediately removed from the site. Random testing may be carried out in accordance with the company policy.

Smoking is allowed only in the designated smoking area, at least 10 metres from any flammable material storage.

Mobile phones must not be used while operating machinery, driving site vehicles or working at height.

Running on site is forbidden. Horseplay and practical jokes are treated as serious misconduct.

5. Housekeeping

Walkways, stairways and emergency exits must be kept clear at all times. Materials must be stacked in a stable manner, no higher than 2 metres unless racking is used. Waste must be removed at the end of each shift and sorted into the dedicated skips (wood, metal, inert, hazardous). Protruding nails must be removed or bent over. Cables and hoses crossing walkways must be protected by cable ramps or routed overhead at a minimum height of 2.5 metres.

6. Working hours and fatigue

Normal working hours are 07:00 to 17:00, Monday to Friday. Work outside these hours requires written approval from the Site Manager. A worker may not work more than 12 hours in a single day or more than 6 consecutive days without a full rest day. Workers must take a break of at least 30 minutes after 6 hours of work.

7. Weather conditions

Outdoor work at height must stop when wind speed exceeds 50 km/h (gusts). Crane operations must stop when wind speed exceeds the limit given in the crane manufacturer's manual, and in any case above 72 km/h. During thunderstorms, all work at height and crane operations stop immediately and workers shelter in site buildings. In hot weather (temperature above 30 C), the supervisor organises extra breaks in the shade and provides drinking water (at least 1 litre per worker per hour of work).

8. Permits to work

A written permit to work, signed by the SSO, is required before starting any of the following high-risk activities: hot work (welding, cutting, grinding near flammable materials), work in confined spaces, excavations deeper than 1.2 metres, work on or near live electrical installations, and lifting operations with a crane. A permit is valid for one shift only and must be displayed at the work location.

For hot work, a fire watch must remain at the location during the work and for at least 60 minutes after it ends. A fire extinguisher must be within 10 metres of the work.

9. Excavations

Excavations deeper than 1.2 metres must be shored, sloped or protected by a trench box before anyone enters. Spoil and materials must be kept at least 1 metre from the edge. Excavations must be inspected by a competent person at the start of each shift and after rain. A safe means of access (ladder or ramp) must be provided every 7.5 metres along the trench.

10. Electrical safety

Only qualified electricians may work on electrical installations. Portable electrical tools must be supplied at 110 V or protected by a residual current device (RCD) of 30 mA. Tools and extension leads are inspected every 3 months and marked with a colour-coded tag. Damaged cables must be taken out of service immediately.

11. Emergency arrangements

The emergency assembly point is shown on the site plan at the entrance. The site alarm is a continuous siren. On hearing the alarm, stop work, make equipment safe if this can be done without risk, and go to the assembly point. The supervisor carries out a head count against the daily attendance list.

At least one trained first aider must be present on site for every 25 workers. The first aid kit and the eye-wash station are located in the site office. The emergency phone number (112) and the address of the nearest hospital are displayed at the site entrance and in every site cabin.

An evacuation drill is carried out at least every 6 months.